CRADLE

The claims an AI agent makes, checked before you read them — every path resolved, every act from a closed vocabulary, a frame that does not hold taken out of play.

4
parts composed:
sword · defender · sentinel · memory

0
third-party Python
dependencies

0
hardware purchased
by this grant

THE FAILURE

A sentence that reads verified and checks nothing.

A path

`"I updated the config at src/core/settings.py"`

The file does not exist. Nothing in the loop stats it.

A command

`"tests pass"`

No command was run, or a different one was, or it failed and the summary did not.

An outcome

`"the issue is fixed"`

The edit landed; the behaviour was never observed. Those are two different claims.

Bigger models lower the rate. They do not make the claim checkable.

THE CHAIN

One command. Four parts. A refusal with a name on it.




```
POST /aio → 422 { state, problems }
```

Refused, and **no prompt is returned**. The caller learns which claim failed, not a softer version of the answer.

WHY IT IS INFRASTRUCTURE

Local, vendor-neutral, and it cannot become the risk it audits.

- ✓ Never holds weights, never needs an API key
- ✓ Speaks the OpenAI chat shape — Ollama, llama.cpp, LM Studio, vLLM
- ✓ Standard library only, so the verifier adds no supply chain
- ✓ Same check against whatever model you install next

The three commands

```
cradle.py --doctor
cradle.py --demo
cradle.py --serve --model-url …
```

`--demo` includes a deliberate failed verification, so a lesson is seen to be written and then recalled.

A commons artefact: the vocabulary and the lesson format published as a spec others can implement.

WHERE IT ACTUALLY STANDS

Both halves, or neither is true.

Exists and is measurable

- ✓ Four parts, composition, three commands, five endpoints
- ✓ Eight chain tests that **skip** when a sibling is absent — never weakened
- ✓ Reference platform documented: Core Ultra 9 285H, Arc 140T 8 GB, 32 GB

Does not exist yet

- × No independent security review — the refusal path has never been read by anyone else
- × One maintainer; docs assume the author's machine
- × Windows-first; Linux and macOS untested
- × **No measured catch rate** — so no efficacy claim is made

The last line is the reason for this application.

WHAT THE GRANT BUYS

Six deliverables, each written so that it can fail.

D1 · Corpus

300 labelled agent claims, 150 resolving / 150 not, provenance per claim.

D2 · Catch rate

Confusion matrix with a lower bound. **A poor number is published as it stands.**

D3 · Portability

Linux and macOS pass `--doctor` and `--demo`; interpreter matrix per platform.

D4 · Review

Independent reviewer, findings published in full — including the unfixed ones.

D5 · Spec

Vocabulary, frame lifecycle, refusal reasons, lesson format. A third party implements from it.

D6 · First run

A stranger reaches a refusal and can say why, without reading the source.

THE ASK

€49,500

12 MONTHS

— Personnel, half time — €31,000

— Independent review — €6,000

— Docs, spec, packaging — €3,500

— Rented compute — €2,500

— Dissemination — €2,000

— Contingency 10% — €4,500

Equipment: €0

No GPU is requested. CRADLE has no training step and no GPU code path; the compute line is rented serving hours at published on-demand rates.

A justification of the form "RTX 4090 for stdlib-only orchestration" would be neither true nor necessary, and is not made.

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